ZABRANJENO PUŠENJE

Jezgro ***Zabranjenog pušenja*** izraslo je iz grupe ***Pseudobluz bend***. Prvu postavu Pušenja sačinjavali su pjevač Nenad Janković (Nele Karajlić), bubnjar Zenit Đozić, gitaristi Mustafa Čengić Muće i Davor Sučić (Sejo Sexon), basista Mladen Mitić (Munja Strašni) i na duvačkim instrumentima Ognjen Gajić. Već početkom osamdesetih nastaju njihovi prvi snimci pjesama "Penzioneri na more idu zimi" i "Čejeni odlaze." Većina članova početkom osamdesetih odlazi u vojsku i tek od 1982. rade punom parom. Pridružili su im se Neletov brat Dražen Janković (Seid Little Karajlić) i bubnjar Predrag Rakić (Šeki Gayton). Oni su snimili prvi kultni album Das ist Walter (1984).

Uslijedila je turneja po Jugoslaviji. Na koncertu krajem novembra 1984. u Rijeci kada im je otkazalo pojačalo Nele je rekao da je "Crk'o maršal." Bezazlena igra riječi izazvala je uzbunu u redovima "čuvara tekovina". Dvostruki drugi album Dok čekaš sabah sa šejtanom (1985) je ponudio antologijsku Nedelja kad je otiš'o Hase u kojoj se kroz priču o oproštaju od fudbala legendarnog Asima Ferhatovića zapravo govorilo o Jugoslaviji nakon Tita.

LP Pozdrav iz zemlje Safari (1987) snimili su novi članovi gitarista Predrag Kovačević (pseudonim Dragan Kowalski) basista režiser Emir Kusturica i bubnjar mladi Faris Arapović. I opet je bilo problema. Sporna je bila Dan republike, Kusturica je režirao spot za pjesmu "Manijak", ali on nije emitovan zbog spornih scena (manijak parkira mercedes ispred zgrade Savezne skupštine).

Album Male priče o velikoj ljubavi (1989) sniman je u turobnoj atmosferi. Osjećalo se da se raspadaju grupa i država oko nje. Album je bio okrenut aktuelnim zbivanjima u Jugoslaviji. Novi basista je Darko Ostojić, klavijaturista Jadranko Džihan a prvi put se pojavljuje violinista Dejan Sparavalo.

Početkom rata Nele odlazi u Beograd i 1996. reaktivira Zabranjeno pušenje. U postavi su Nele, njegov brat Dražen, Sparavalo, gitarista Goran Jakovljević, basista Goran Markovski, a za bubnjevima je Stribor Kusturica, sin nekadašnjeg basiste Emira. Snimili su CD Ja nisam odavde (1997). Nele je radio muziku za Kusturičine filmove Crna mačka beli mačor, Život je čudo, i Na mliječnom putu. Emir Kusturica and the No smoking orchestra su objavili album Unza unza time (2000). Po predlošku filma Dom za vešanje urađena je rock opera The Time of Gypsies, a muziku je radio Nele.

Sejo Sexon je tokom prvih ratnih godina u Sarajevu radio Top listu nadrealista. Preselio se u Zagreb gde je sa Elvisom obnovio Zabranjeno pušenje a pjevao je Marin Gradec Maka. Snimili su CD Filžan viška (1997), koncertni Hapsi sve! (1998.) i Agent tajne sile (1999). Na albumu Bog vozi mercedes (2001) Sejo je postao glavni pjevač. Krajem 2002. svirali su po SAD što je zabeleženo na disku Live In St. Louis. Sejo je uradio muziku za film Jasmina Durakovića Nafaka, a dio toga je na dvostrukom albumu Hodi da ti čiko nešto da (2006). Nastavili su albumima Muzej revolucije (2009), Radovi na cesti (2013), Šok i nevjerica (2018) i Karamba! (2022).

The core of Zabranjeno pušenje emerged from Pseudobluz bend (Pseudo Blues Band). The first lineup of Pušenje consisted of singer Nenad Janković (Nele Karajlić), drummer Zenit Đozić, guitarists Mustafa Čengić Muće and Davor Sučić (Sejo Sexon), bassist Mladen Mitić (Munja Strašni), and Ognjen Gajić on wind instruments. Already in the early 80s, the first recordings of the songs "Penzioneri na more idu zimi" ("Pensioners Go to the Coast in Winter)" and "Čejeni odlaze" ("Cheyennes are Leaving)" were made. Most of the band members did their compulsory service in the Yugoslav People's Army (JNA) in the early 80s and resumed full time work in 1982. They were joined by Nele's brother Dražen Janković (Seid Little Karajlić) and drummer Predrag Rakić (Šeki Gayton). They recorded the first cult album Das ist Walter (That's Walter) in 1984.

A Yugoslav tour then followed. At a concert in Rijeka, at the end of November 1984, when their amplifier [note: with the brand name Marshall] failed, Nele said that "Marshall dropped dead (Crk'o maršal)." [Note: Tito was known as Marshall.] The harmless play on words alarmed the "guardians of heritage." The double second album Dok čekaš sabah sa šejtanom (While You Wait for Dawn with the Devil) (1985) offered the anthology track "Nedelja kad je otiš'o Hase" ("Sunday When Hase Left)" in which the story of the legendary Asim Ferhatović's farewell to football was actually about Yugoslavia after Tito.

The LP Pozdrav iz zemlje Safari (Greetings from Safari Land) (1987) was recorded with new band members, guitarist Predrag Kovačević (pseudonym Dragan Kowalski), bassist and movie director Emir Kusturica, and young drummer Faris Arapović. And again, there were problems. "Dan republike" ("Republic Day)" was controversial; and Kusturica directed the music video for the song "Manijac" ("The Maniac)", but it was not broadcast due to controversial scenes (the maniac parks a Mercedes in front of the Federal Assembly).

The album Male priče o velikoj ljubavi (Small Stories about Big Love) (1989) was recorded in a gloomy atmosphere. One could sense that the band, as well as the state around it, were falling apart. The album was focused on current events in Yugoslavia. New bassist Darko Ostojić, keyboardist Jadranko Džihan, and violinist Dejan Sparavalo appeared for the first time.

At the beginning of the war, Nele left for Belgrade and reactivated Zabranjeno pušenje in 1996. The lineup consisted of Nele, his brother Dražen, Sparavalo, guitarist Goran Jakovljević, bassist Goran Markovski, and drummer Stribor Kusturica, the son of former bassist Emir. They recorded a CD, Ja nisam odavle (I am Not from Here) (1997). Nele made music for Kusturica's movies Crna mačka, beli mačor (Black Cat, White Cat), Život je čudo (Life is a Miracle), and Na mliječnom putu (On the Milky Way). A band called Emir Kusturica and the No Smoking Orchestra released the album Unza Unza Time (2000). The rock opera Time of the Gypsies was made based on the movie Dom za vješanje; Nele composed the music.

During the first years of the war, Sejo Sexon worked on Top lista nadrealista. He moved to Zagreb where he restarted Zabranjeno pušenje with Elvis. The singer was Marin Gradec Maka. They recorded the CD Fildžan viška (An Extra Cup of Coffee) (1997), the live album Hapsi sve! (Arrest Everyone!) (1998), and Agent tajne sile (Secret Force Agent) (1999). Sejo became the lead singer on the album Bog vozi Mercedes (God Drives a Mercedes) (2001). By the end of 2002, they performed across the USA, as documented on the CD, Live in St. Louis. Sejo composed music for Jasmin Duraković's movie Nafaka, and part of it is included in the double album Hodi da ti čiko nešto da (Let Uncle Give You Something) (2006). They continued with the albums Muzej revolucije (Museum of the Revolution) (2009), Radovi na cesti (Road Works)(2013), Šok i nevjerica (Shock and Disbelief) (2018), and Karamba! (2022).